

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 997

By Powell

A RESOLUTION to honor Nashville SC, 2025 Lamar Hunt U.S. Open Cup champions.

WHEREAS, Nashville SC, one of the most beloved and dynamic soccer teams in this country, claimed its first-ever tournament trophy by winning the 2025 Lamar Hunt U.S. Open Cup championship, the nation's oldest and longest-running soccer tournament; and

WHEREAS, by defeating Austin FC 2-1 on October 1, 2025, Nashville SC not only won its first trophy but also became the first professional sports team in the State of Tennessee to win a national championship; and

WHEREAS, this victory marked a historic triumph for Nashville SC and the city itself. A dozen years after a scrappy, supporter-owned amateur side first took the field at Vanderbilt's lacrosse venue, Nashville SC—a different iteration of that same club—claimed American soccer's most storied trophy, crowning more than a decade of achievements; and

WHEREAS, as the 2025 Lamar Hunt U.S. Open Cup champions, Nashville SC has now qualified to compete in the prestigious 2026 CONCACAF Champions Cup and will face championship teams from across CONCACAF in the tournament; and

WHEREAS, Nashville's path to glory saw the team defeat Chattanooga Red Wolves SC (1-0), Orlando (3-2), D.C. United (5-2), Philadelphia (3-1), before downing Austin FC (2-1) in Texas behind an early goal from 2022 MLS MVP Hany Mukhtar and a tremendous penalty kick by the team's leading scorer, Sam Surridge; and

WHEREAS, Hany Mukhtar and Sam Surridge once again delivered when it mattered most, each finding the net for Nashville; the match belonged less to individual brilliance than to collective determination—a squad-wide refusal to be denied. From the first whistle to the final

kick of the ball, it was a complete team effort as the starters laid a solid foundation, and those who entered as substitutes raised the level of play even higher; and

WHEREAS, the Boys in Gold lacing them up for Nashville SC in the championship match included Sam Surridge, Hany Mukhtar, Jacob Shaffelburg, Alex Muyl, Daniel Lovitz, Eddi Tagseth, Patrick Yazbek, Andy Najar, Jack Maher, Jeisson Palacios, Brian Schwake, Xavier Valdez, Teal Bunbury, Bryan Acosta, Josh Bauer, Gastón Brugman, Walker Zimmerman, and Tyler Boyd; and

WHEREAS, Nashville SC is led by head coach B.J. Callaghan, who brought glory to Nashville SC in his first full season as head coach and first professional head coaching role; he has a history of greatness, having won the 2023 CONCACAF Nations League with the U.S. Men's National Team as an interim head coach; and

WHEREAS, Nashville SC played with the heart and soul of champions throughout the tournament, and its players, coaches, and staff are worthy of our approbation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Nashville SC on winning the 2025 Lamar Hunt U.S. Open Cup, thank the team's players, coaches, and staff for their tremendous performance on the pitch, and extend to them our best wishes for many more years of continued success and tournament victories.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.